The Hillingdon Hospitals
NHS Foundation Trust

Maternity Department Lift Failure

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Change History

Version	Author	Summary of changes
1.0	Julie Cooper, Director of Midwifery	New SOP following a CQC “Must do”

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It is your responsibility to check against the intranet that this printout is the most recent version of this document.

Aims/Purpose

The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) is to identify what to do if any of the passenger lifts in the maternity department breakdown at Hillingdon Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust.

The aims of the SOP are:

- To ensure the safety of all staff, patients and visitors within the maternity department in the event of the lift/s failing to work.

Introduction

Background

It is the intention of the estates department to provide a safe means of vertical transportation within the Trust to meet the requirements of different user groups.

There are 2 staff, patient and visitor transport lifts within the maternity department that provide transport to all 4 levels of the maternity building.

Scope

This SOP applies to all maternity staff working within the maternity department at Hillingdon Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust.

The Guidance

Roles and Responsibilities

Maternity Department:

- On discovery of the failure of the lift/s in the maternity department the following actions should take place:
    - Identify if any patients, visitors, or staff are trapped in the lift and provide ongoing communication to those trapped.
    - Report the breakdown to the estates department on Ext 3720 and via the Estates Self Service Helpdesk app on the intranet. Progress on the repair of the lift/s can also be monitored via the estates self-service helpdesk app.
    - Inform the Maternity Bleep Holder on bleep 5763 or by mobile phone number - 07789 746505.
    - Inform the Clinical Site Practitioner (CSP) on Bleep 5830.

- Ensure that any persons trapped in the lift are rescued in a timely manner and check on their welfare.
- Ensure that a transport incubator (shuttle) is moved from the neonatal unit to the labour ward and place by the maternity theatres to support any babies requiring neonatal care.
- Place a sign on the broken down lift/s and ensure that a safety barrier is placed in front of the lift doors on every floor.
- Inform the facilities team that a maternity lift/s is not working.

Estates Department:

- Ensure regular maintenance and servicing of the lifts to reduce lift failures.
- Respond to lift failures and ensure appropriate actions are taken to repair the lift in a timely manner.
- Ensure regular communication with the maternity department via the maternity bleep holder on Bleep 5763 on the progress of the lift repair.

Actions to take if both lifts fail.

- As well as the actions above, if both lifts have failed, the following actions should take place:
  - Please ensure that the CSP is aware that both lifts have failed as this event will be a major incident and the Emergency Preparedness, Resilience and Response Policy will need to be activated.
  - Activate the Maternity Escalation and Divert Policy.
  - In hours inform the Director of Midwifery or delegated deputy.

Associated Guidelines, Polices and Documents

1. Roles and Responsibilities of Maternity Bleep (5763) Holder
2. Emergency preparedness, Resilience and Response Policy.
3. Maternity Escalation and Divert Policy.

Training Need Identified

- Specific training will be identified on an individual basis.
- Training will be provided to all members of staff holding the maternity bleep.

Implementation and Monitoring

All guidelines, protocols and procedures are available on the intranet. All staff have a responsibility to check the Trust's intranet and ensure that they are referring to the most recent issue of the document. The weekly general information bulletin includes notification of publication of new/updated documents.

Audit

An annual audit will be undertaken by the senior midwifery management team to identify the number of breakdowns per year and any lessons learnt. The audit will be disseminated to all maternity staff.

References

No references

Appendices

Appendix 1: Lift out of Order sign

Appendices

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LIFT OUT OF ORDER PLEASE USE THE STAIRS